

Series Title: The Power of Promises

Dates: September 7 - 28

Vision For The Event

This sermon series, *The Power of Promises*, emphasizes the significance of promises in our relationship with God and each other. The Bible is rich with examples of God's faithfulness in keeping His promises, shaping our understanding of covenant and trust. As members of the United Methodist Church, we also make promises—offering our prayers, presence, gifts, service, and witness. This series prepares the congregation for a renewal of these vows, inspiring a recommitment to God and the church.

Through this series, participants will:

- Explore biblical promises and their transformative power.
- Reflect on the promises they have made to God and the church.
- Prepare their hearts for a meaningful recommitment of their vows.

The Goals of the Series

- Deepen the congregation's understanding of God's covenantal faithfulness.
- Encourage reflection on personal and communal commitments.
- Inspire renewed dedication to the vows of membership in the United Methodist Church.

Sermon Schedule

Sunday	Sermon Title	Scripture
9/7/25	The Promise of Proximity	Luke 22:14-20
9/14/25	Promise Over Prediction	Ruth 1:6-18
9/21/25	The Promise We Thought We Wanted	Joshua 4:1-9
9/28/25	New and Renewed	Jeremiah 31:27-34

Synopses

Week 1 | The Promise of Proximity | Luke 22:14-20

This sermon focuses on the promise of proximity, rooted in the new covenant established by Jesus at the Last Supper. God's promises draw us closer to Him, binding us in a relationship of love and grace. Through the breaking of bread and sharing of the cup, Jesus offers a tangible sign of this covenant, demonstrating that God's promises are not distant declarations but intimate acts of closeness and care. The message invites the congregation to consider how their promises can bring them closer to God and one another.

Week 2 | Promise over Prediction | Ruth 1:6-18

In this sermon, the focus shifts to the power of promises over predictions. Ruth's unwavering commitment to Naomi illustrates how promises create bonds that transcend circumstances. Unlike predictions, which are uncertain and often fail, promises generate trust, community, and purpose. Ruth's covenant to stay with Naomi embodies steadfast loyalty and faith, encouraging the congregation to embrace their promises to God and others as acts of transformative love.

Week 3 | The Promise We Thought We Wanted | Joshua 4:1-9

This sermon examines the Israelites' memorial of stones after crossing the Jordan River as a testament to God's fulfilled promises. Often, the promises we think we want

pale in comparison to God's greater plans. The story of the stones reminds us of the importance of remembering and honoring God's faithfulness. By reflecting on these "ebenezers," the congregation is encouraged to recognize how God's promises have shaped their lives and consider how their commitments can leave a legacy of faith for future generations.

Week 4 | New and Renewed | Jeremiah 31:27-34

The series concludes with a focus on the promise of a new covenant. Jeremiah's prophecy highlights God's initiative to renew and restore His people. This sermon invites the congregation to reflect on their vows to God and the church, culminating in a communal renewal of United Methodist membership vows. This act of recommitment underscores the enduring power of God's promises and the transformative potential of our faithful response.